

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 5 2
♥ J 10 4
♦ 9 6 2
♣ Q 10 9 4

♠ J 9 7

♥ A 5

♦ A K J 10 3

♣ A K 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q 10 4

♥ 9 8 6 2

♦ 5 4

♣ 8 5 3

♠ A 6 3

♥ K Q 7 3

♦ Q 8 7

♣ J 7 2

West	North	East	South
	2NT	Pass	4NT
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			

6NT by North
know East holds ♠Q). In fact, you should even give him some incentive to play another ♠ by dropping your ♠9, pretending to hold just the ♠ J 9. But East noticed his partner's discouraging ♠2 and switched to the ♣8.

You try the ♣J but West plays the ♣Q and you have to win with your ♣K.

Your chances for success are slipping away and you are down to your last hope. Your ♠J is a threat that only East can guard against. If East also is the defender with long ♥s then he would also have to guard dummy's fourth ♥. In that case you could squeeze him. But there is one important play you must make for the squeeze to function.

You must play dummy's ♠A to unblock so your ♠J can be the threat you need. Then play the ♥A, ♣A and 5 ♦ winners.

If East has thrown the ♠Q you win your ♠J and dummy's two high ♥s. But since he probably held onto the ♠Q you just play a ♥ to dummy and hope all three ♥s are winners.

Since East had to guard both the ♥s and your ♠J, he was unable to do both, and the squeeze worked.

You were lucky it wasn't West with the 4 ♥s.

Because of his 3-4-3-3 distribution, partner chose not to look for a ♥ fit. If he had opted for Stayman the contract would have turned out the same. The 4NT response is quantitative, inviting you to bid 6NT if you have a maximum.

You do. 6NT.

North plays 6NT. East leads the ♠K. You will have to make an early decision on whether to hold up or not.

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 3 : ♦ = 5 : ♣ = 2 :: Total = 11

Only one more winner is needed. You should play a low ♠ from dummy in the hope that East will lead the suit again, giving you a trick with your ♠J (you

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 3
♥ 10 9 7 4
♦ K 7 6 5 4 2
♣ 10

♠ J 9 8 6 2

♥ Q 2

♦ A Q

♣ 8 7 4 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 5
♥ A K 6 5
♦ J 10 3
♣ Q J 9 5

♠ A K Q 4

♥ J 8 3

♦ 9 8

♣ A K 6 2

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♥	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by South

So what are you going to discard right now on that ♥J? It looks obvious to discard the ♦Q; then if the ♣s do split 3-2 (68% chance) you will be home free, losing only two ♥s and one ♣.

Throwing the ♦Q is a bad idea. And basically unnecessary. If the ♣s are splitting 3-2 you don't need to keep a fourth ♣ in both hands. So discard a small ♣ from dummy and keep the ♦Q just in case the ♣s turn out 4-1 and you have to fall back on the ♦finesse.

Looking at all four hands you can see why you needed to keep the ♦Q.

After you pull trumps you play the top two ♣s and discover (too late) that you cannot set up a ♣ winner.

But what if the ♦K was actually with East, and the ♣s were splitting 3-2 all the time?

In this scenario it is still ok to discard a small ♣ from dummy.

You pull trumps first, then play two top ♣s. When both defenders follow you give up a ♣. West wins and plays a ♦, but you go up with dummy's ♦A, enter your hand with a trump and **NOW** discard that ♦Q on your good ♣.

Partner expects you to bid 2♠.

But your hand has suddenly increased in value - with the known ♠ fit you add another point for your doubleton and you have 18 points. So you jump to 3♠; this is called a Super-Accept. But so what. Partner just bids the game anyway.

South plays 4♠. West leads the ♥10. East plays the ♥K, then ♥A, then ♥5.

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 2 :: Total = 5

You need to eliminate two losers. If West has the ♦K a finesse will save one loser. If ♣s split 3-2 that will eliminate one loser. And of course your ♥J is ready to provide an immediate discard.